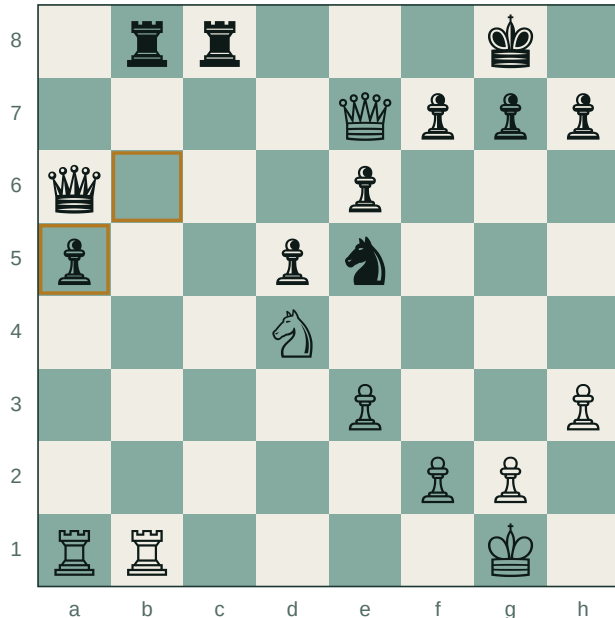


Forks and double attacks: White, move 30

Forks and double attacks

White to move



Previous move: 29...bxa5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

30. Rxb8 Rxb8 31. Qc7 Rc8 32. Qxe5

30.Rxb8 The rook captures the rook on b8. Recorded reply: **30...Rxb8**.

31.Qc7 The queen moves from e7 to c7. From c7 it attacks rook on b8 and knight on e5. Recorded reply: **31...Rc8**.

32.Qxe5 The queen captures the knight on e5.

At the end, nominal material is White 21 / Black 20 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: queen on a6 and knight on e5. Check for tactical protection.